



Informed Consent to Participate in Research

Veteran Housing Benefit Eligibility Snapshot — Usability Study

Study Title

Usability Evaluation of a Veteran Housing Benefit Eligibility Snapshot Interface

Principal Investigator

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INTRODUCTION AND PURPOSE

You are invited to participate in a research study. Before you decide whether to participate, please read this form carefully and ask any questions you may have.

This study is being conducted by a DePaul University graduate student as part of an Independent Study project under faculty advisement. The purpose of this study is to evaluate the usability of a web-based interface called the Veteran Housing Benefit Eligibility Snapshot — a tool designed to help veterans quickly understand which housing benefit pathways that they may be eligible for

You are being invited to participate because you are a U.S. veteran or a person who works with veterans in a housing or benefits context.

WHAT YOU WILL BE ASKED TO DO

If you agree to participate, you will be asked to:

1. Use a prototype web interface on a provided device (laptop or tablet).
2. Complete 2 to 4 short tasks using the interface while thinking aloud — meaning you will narrate your thoughts as you work.
3. Answer brief follow-up questions about your experience.

The session will last approximately 45 to 60 minutes.

RISKS AND BENEFITS

Risks

This study involves minimal risk. There are no medical procedures, no collection of benefits-related personal data, and no financial costs to you. You will not be asked for your Social Security Number, VA claim number, full date of birth, or any other personally identifying information.

If you find any task frustrating or uncomfortable, you may skip it or stop at any time.

Benefits

There is no direct personal benefit to you from participating. However, your feedback will directly improve a tool intended to help veterans navigate housing benefit processes more effectively.

WHAT INFORMATION WILL BE COLLECTED

The researcher will collect:

- Written observational notes (task behaviors, navigation patterns, verbal comments)
- Your responses to follow-up questions (spoken or written)
- Optional: a brief demographic form asking your general familiarity with online tools and veteran services (no identifying information)

No audio recordings, video recordings, or screen recordings will be made during this session unless you separately provide written permission on the recording consent supplement.

No personally identifying information will be collected. All session notes will be de-identified before storage or analysis.

HOW YOUR INFORMATION WILL BE USED

Data from this study will be used solely for academic research purposes as part of the IS-001 Independent Study project at DePaul University. Findings may be included in a written research report submitted to the faculty advisor. No individual participant data will be shared with any third party, government agency, or employer. De-identified aggregate findings may be shared in academic presentations or publications.

CONFIDENTIALITY

Your participation is confidential to the extent permitted by law. Session notes will not include your name. You will be assigned a participant code (e.g., P01, P02) for all records. Your name will not appear in any report or presentation. Raw session notes will be stored in a password-protected environment and deleted after the project is complete.

PARTICIPATION IS VOLUNTARY

Your participation in this study is entirely voluntary. You may choose not to participate, skip any task or question, or withdraw at any time without penalty or consequence. Refusal to participate will not affect your relationship with DePaul University, the researcher, or any VA services you receive.

QUESTIONS

If you have questions about this study, please contact:

Chad DeWitt King
cking70@depaul.edu

If you have questions about your rights as a research participant, you may contact DePaul University's Office of Research Integrity:

Office of Research Integrity
DePaul University
1 E. Jackson Blvd., Suite 9100
Chicago, IL 60604
research@depaul.edu

CONSENT STATEMENT

By signing below, I confirm that:

- I have read and understand this consent form.
- I have had the opportunity to ask questions and they have been answered.
- I am 18 years of age or older.
- I voluntarily agree to participate in this study.
- I understand that I may withdraw at any time without penalty.

Participant Signature: _____

Printed Name: _____

Date: _____

Researcher Signature: _____

Printed Name: Chad DeWitt King

Date: _____